Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣5

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♥3

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ A 10 4
♦ K 9
♣ Q J 10 8 5

♠ J 6 5
♥ 8 5 2
♦ J 8 7 6 5
♣ A 3



♠ 8 4 3
♥ K J 6
♦ 10 3 2
♣ K 7 4 2

♠ A 10 9 2
♥ Q 9 7 3
♦ A Q 4
♣ 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♠4

SOUTH's 2♣ bid is Stayman, asking for a 4-card Major.

NORTH's 2♦ bid denies four cards in either Major.

SOUTH knows there is no 8-card Major fit. He also knows the partnership has at least 26 points so he bids 3NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 2 ♥ J 10 5 4 ♦ 8 7 4 ♣ K 9 5 4	
♠ K J 8 7 5 4 ♥ 8 6 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ 7 2		♠ Q 10 ♥ K Q 9 3 ♦ A 5 2 ♣ A 10 8 6
	♠ A 6 3 ♥ A 7 2 ♦ J 10 9 6 ♣ Q J 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST, with 11 points and six ♠s, knows immediately that the final contract will be 4♠ since the partners must have at least eight ♠s and at least 26 points.

She concludes that it might be better for EAST to be the Declarer so she bids 2♥ as a Jacoby Transfer. When EAST makes the required 2♠ bid she just bids 4♠ which closes the auction with EAST as Declarer.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 6 4 3
♥ A K J 7 6 5
♦ 8 2
♣ Q 7

♠ A 8 2
♥ 8 2
♦ Q 10 9 4
♣ 9 8 5 2



♠ Q J 10 9
♥ 10 4
♦ A J 6 3
♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 3
♦ K 7 5
♣ A K J 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣5

NORTH knows the partnership has a fit in ♥s since SOUTH must have at least a doubleton. He also knows the partnership holds at least 27 points.

He prefers SOUTH be the Declarer, (to protect against the opening lead), so he uses a Jacoby Transfer.

The contract might go down if played by NORTH, but is odds on when played by SOUTH.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 8 4 2 ♥ 9 3 2 ♦ A 6 ♣ A Q 6 2	
♠ A K 6 5 ♥ A 10 4 ♦ Q J 9 7 ♣ K 8		♠ 7 3 ♥ K Q 8 6 ♦ K 4 2 ♣ J 10 9 5
	♠ Q J 9 ♥ J 7 5 ♦ 10 8 5 3 ♣ 7 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			

3NT by West
Lead: ♥3

EAST, with 9 points and a 4-card ♥ suit is just strong enough to use Stayman.

WEST shows 4 ♠s and EAST describes her minimum hand with no ♠ fit by bidding 2NT.

WEST has a maximum 1NT opening and bids 3NT.